Chapter 17

Globalization, Democratization, and Human Rights

Chapter Focus

Should I, as a citizen, respond to globalization? In this chapter, you will have a chance to continue your investigation into this Main Issue for Part 4 as you analyze the relationship between globalization, democracy, and human rights. What rights do you have in a democracy? If you have rights and freedoms, do you also have responsibilities? If so, what are they?

We all belong to many different communities, such as our school, cultural group, hometown, province, and country. We are all citizens of the world, too. What does it mean to be a global citizen? What rights and responsibilities do we have as global citizens? To become a responsible global citizen, it is important that you develop a global perspective, one in which you respect the rights, values, and points of view of all people, everywhere.

Key Terms

universality
ratify
genocide
Falun Gong
prisoner of conscience
authoritarian

Chapter Issue

In this chapter, you will have the opportunity to explore the fundamentals of our human rights and consider the impact that globalization has on human rights and democracy. Through these discussions, you will continue to explore the Chapter Issue: ***To what extent does globalization affect access to human rights?***

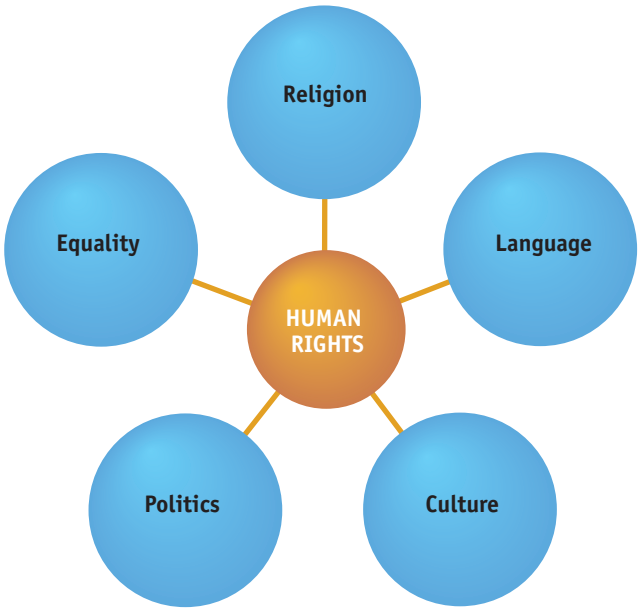


Figure 17-1 This concept web highlights the key elements of human rights. What other things, if any, could you add to this web?

Conduct a Thorough Discussion

SKILL PATH

One way to think creatively is to build a framework for conducting a thorough discussion about a topic. Whether you are working individually or in groups, you can put on different-coloured "hats" to direct your thinking in meaningful ways.* With each hat you wear, you take a particular approach to a topic or issue. You can apply this creative thinking skill as you explore the Chapter Issue: ***To what extent does globalization affect access to human rights?***

Your Task: Work in groups to think creatively and identify which human rights and freedoms you, as a class, value most. Read the Universal Declaration of Human Rights (either by following the links on the *Living in a Globalizing World* website or from a copy provided by your teacher). One member of each group will record the ideas that come up during your discussion. Once you have completed your group discussion, share your ideas as a class, and apply your knowledge and understanding to create your own class Declaration of Human Rights.

Web Link

Figure 17-2 When you use the *Six Thinking Hats* method of thinking, you work in a sequence. First you explore the problem. Then you develop a set of solutions. Finally you choose a solution by critically examining the options.

Step 1

Blue Hat Thinking: Manage the Thinking Process

Blue Hat Thinking sets the focus for your thinking. It establishes the "big picture" and gets you to reflect on your own thinking—for example, how you solved a problem, what strategies you used, and what you might do differently or the same the next time. When you are wearing the Blue Hat, ask yourself these questions:

- What is the focus of my thinking?
- What things have I thought about so far?
- What things should I think about next?

Step 2

White Hat Thinking: Focus on the Information

White Hat Thinking gets you to focus on facts, figures, and other objective information. You find out what you can learn from the information you have and look for gaps in your knowledge. When you are wearing the White Hat, ask yourself these questions:

- What information do I have?
- What more information do I need to make a decision?
- How can I get this information?

Step 3

Red Hat Thinking: Get in Touch with Your Emotions

Red Hat Thinking requires you to look at something emotionally and intuitively. When you are wearing the Red Hat, you are getting in touch with your feelings. You can collect different opinions and react to them. When you are wearing the Red Hat, ask yourself these questions:

- How do I feel about this?
- What is my gut reaction?
- What is the most important thing I learned?

*Note: This Skill Path is based on a thinking strategy developed by Edward De Bono in his book *Six Thinking Hats*, Little, Brown and Company, 1985.

Step 4

Black Hat Thinking: Analyze the Negatives

Black Hat Thinking analyzes the problems and difficulties of a topic. It requires that you look at all of the negative effects of a decision and try to identify reasons why it might not work. This is the hat of judgment. It must always be logical by considering the advantages and disadvantages of any action. When you are wearing the Black Hat, ask yourself these questions:

- What are the drawbacks?
- What are the weaknesses?
- What is the worst-case scenario?

Step 5

Yellow Hat Thinking: Analyze the Positives

Yellow Hat Thinking analyzes the positive aspects of a topic. It requires that you look for opportunities, possibilities, and benefits. When you are wearing the Yellow Hat, ask yourself these questions:

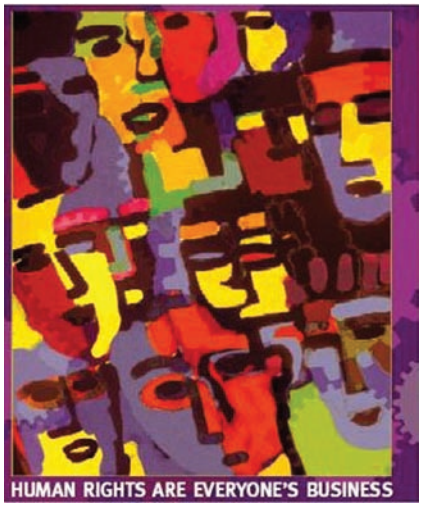
- What are the positive aspects?
- What are the strengths?
- What is the best possible outcome?

Step 6

Green Hat Thinking: Find New Ideas

Green Hat Thinking requires you to use your imagination to find creative new ideas and approaches to a topic. It encourages you to speculate about possible alternatives that will allow you to view something in a new way. When you are wearing the Green Hat, ask yourself these questions:

- What other ideas about this topic do I have?
- How did I reach this conclusion?
- Why do I think this?



The Globalization of Human Rights

Question for Inquiry

- **What are our human rights, and how are they promoted in a global world?**

Figure 17-3 This human rights poster is published by the Alberta government. What message does the poster convey? Why do you think governments produce posters and pamphlets about human rights? What impact does this poster's message have on you?

What Are Human Rights?

universality applicable to all persons or things in the world

All people in the world are entitled to certain rights simply because we are all human beings. Rights are those things that we are allowed to be, do, or have. They protect us from violence, abuse, ignorance, and hatred. They help us get along in a world of many diverse languages, religions, and cultures. Human rights are about respecting one another. Organizations like the United Nations (UN) believe that human rights are global, meaning that they apply in all countries and cultures. In this section, you will have the opportunity to learn about human rights and examine two points of view about the **universality** of human rights and their impact in a global world.

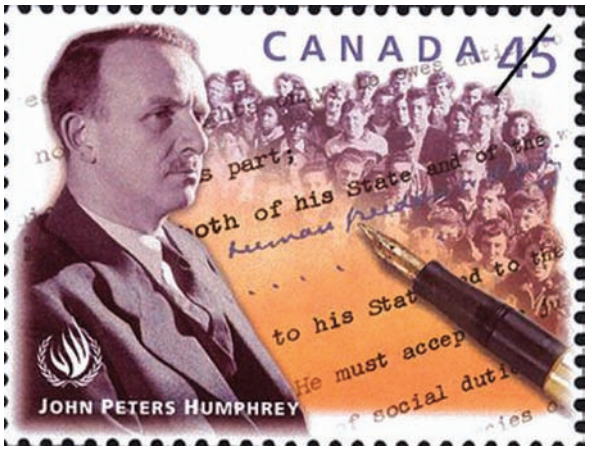


Figure 17-4 In 1998, Canada Post issued this stamp in honour of John Humphrey, a Canadian law professor who became the first director of the UN Human Rights Division. In 1947, Humphrey wrote the original draft of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights. However, he was not formally recognized for this work until the original draft of the Declaration, with his handwritten notes, was discovered in 1988. To what extent do you think Canada upholds its commitment to human rights?

The United Nations and Human Rights

Since time immemorial, all societies have valued their own sets of human rights. However, after the Second World War, the countries of the newly established United Nations worked together to create the Universal Declaration of Human Rights in 1948. The Declaration sent a message to all peoples and countries around the world: human rights are global. They apply to everyone, everywhere, at all times. By signing the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, a country commits itself to protecting the rights of its citizens. Since the Declaration is not a treaty, however, it is not legally binding. Therefore, it is not easy to enforce it. Still, the Declaration has the power to apply moral and diplomatic pressure on governments to respect human rights. How important is it to have a Universal Declaration of Human Rights in today's world? What factors might determine the extent to which human rights can be applied globally?

Although many countries have **ratified** the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, the nature of human rights is controversial. There are many diverse cultures and religions in the world. Most religions have their own codes of ethics and ideas about right and wrong. Sometimes these are not consistent with some of the human rights outlined in the Declaration. For example, some cultures may object to certain human rights because they conflict with their religious beliefs.

One way that cultures and religions have addressed this issue is by creating their own human rights legislation. The Universal Islamic Declaration of Human Rights is based on the Qur'an and other sources of Islamic law. The African Charter of Human and Peoples' Rights, which reflects the cultural values of African nations, stresses the importance of community and family obligations as well as individual rights. To what extent is it possible for human rights to be universal, regardless of cultural or religious beliefs? Read the following Voices feature to consider this question.

ratify to confirm or accept an agreement by formal consent

Web Link

The Universal Declaration of Human Rights has inspired human rights documents in more than 60 countries, including Canada. You can read the Declaration on the *Living in a Globalizing World* website. To what extent do you promote human rights by respecting diversity and treating everyone equally? How should people respond when they witness, or are victims of, human rights violations?

Voices

Are All Rights Universal?

Not everyone believes that human rights are universal and should apply to all peoples everywhere. Some people maintain that the values of diverse religions and cultures should be respected equally. Others argue that, as an international document created by diverse nations, the Universal Declaration of Human Rights should apply to everyone. Consider the perspectives presented in the quotations below.

It is high time that the West learns from the East the meaning of moral freedom and the true significance of non-material values rather than dictate to the peoples of Asia its own confused and highly selective principles of human rights. …

It is arrogant and hypocritical of any country, on the basis of its material wealth and military might, to dictate to selective countries how to live and how to develop and preserve their values and fundamental rights. …

In today's religiously and culturally pluralistic world, nations must work together for the preservation of moral and spiritual values and the safeguarding of the fundamental rights of liberty, equality before God, and international law and human dignity.

Source: Mahmoud Ayoub, *Asian Spirituality and Human Rights*, Bangkok: Asian Regional Resource Center for Human Rights Education, 2002, http://www.arrc-hre.com/publications/hrepack1/page53.html.

The human rights standards that came into existence after World War II were not legislated by a few powerful nations.… They were drafted by representatives from diverse nations. [They] agreed that state sovereignty could never justify certain governmental practices, such as ***genocide*** *or torture.*

In this light, proponents of universality argue that international human rights norms have moral authority because they constitute the world community's consensus regarding ethical behaviours between governments and their citizens. If one views them from this perspective, it is not hard to make the argument that international human rights norms should be universally applied, giving all peoples the benefit of their protection.

Source: Karen Musalo, "When Rights and Cultures Collide," Issues in Ethics, Vol. 8, No. 3, 1999.

1. What perspectives are presented in each of these quotations?
2. Give an example of one way that race, religion, culture, or language may affect a people's world view and therefore their perspective on human rights.
3. Do you think it is possible to achieve a universal understanding of human rights? Why or why not?

Reading Guide

When you are reading primary sources such as the ones in this Voices feature, keep a dictionary on hand to look up words you don't understand. Record the words and their meanings in your personal glossary.

genocide the mass extermination of human beings

Web Link

Follow the links on the *Living in a Globalizing World* website to the African Charter of Human and Peoples' Rights and the Universal Islamic Declaration of Human Rights, and read these documents. Why would individual states or groups of nations create their own human rights agreements? Should these documents take priority over the Universal Declaration of Human Rights? Why or why not?

Explore the Issues

1. ***Practise Your Skills.*** Can we have rights and freedoms without responsibilities? What responsibilities go along with rights and freedoms? Follow the steps in the Skill Path in this chapter as you discuss these ideas as a class. SKILL PATH

2. ***Brainstorm and Create a Concept Web.*** As a starting point for this activity, refer to Figure 17-1. Brainstorm to create a concept web about human rights in Canada following the steps in the Skill Path in Chapter 1 (pages 7–8). Think of as many connections as you can for each of the five human rights on the concept web. For example, you might extend language rights to include education. From there, you could extend the web further to specify minority language educational rights. Repeat this process for all of the rights in the concept web.

3. ***Learn More about It.*** Select one of the issues from the extended concept web you have created, and research it further using the Skill Path in Chapter 10 (pages 157–158). You may investigate this issue at the local, provincial, national, or international level. As you conduct your research, try to answer the following questions:
   - Whose rights are in question?
   - What rights does this group seek to obtain or protect?
   - What challenges do they face?
   - What are they doing to resolve the issue?

   Submit your findings in an oral or written report.

Threats to Human Rights

Question for Inquiry

- **In what ways do countries violate the human rights of their citizens?**

Some of the world's most repressive countries recycled into new Human Rights Council

[The May 9, 2006] election of 10 of the world's worst violators of free expression—Algeria, Azerbaijan, Bangladesh, China, Cuba, Nigeria, Pakistan, Russia, Saudi Arabia, and Tunisia—to be members of the UN's new Human Rights Council was called a "scandal" today by Reporters Without Borders.

UN Press Release, May 10, 2006

Canada pledges to uphold rights as newly elected member of UN Council

Canada was one of the countries elected Tuesday to the new UN Human Rights Council. … The Council replaces the much politicized UN Human Rights Commission, which was discredited in recent years because some countries with poor human rights records had used their membership to protect one another from condemnation.

Canadian Press, May 10, 2006

In May 2006, the United Nations elected members to sit on the new 47-seat Human Rights Council. Among the countries elected, nine are designated by the democracy watchdog Freedom House as "not free"; 13 others are designated as "partly free."

- What impact do you think the members that violate human rights will have on the Human Rights Council?
- To what extent do you think they could limit its effectiveness?
- How can democratic members such as Canada use their influence to promote human rights and democracy?

READING GUIDE

To help you absorb what you are reading, take turns reading aloud with a partner.

Human rights are important to individuals, communities, and nations. When we respect human rights, we create a foundation for freedom and justice in our society. When we have freedom and justice, we are creating a peaceful society. Yet what happens when human rights are not respected? In this section, you will have the opportunity to explore some examples of human rights violations, here at home and in other parts of the world. As you do, continue to consider the Main Issue for this section: ***Should I, as a citizen, respond to globalization?***

Human Rights in Canada

As a Canadian, what rights do you have? Do you have the right to an education? Do you have the right to attend a school where instruction is in your first language? Do you have the right to health care? Do all people in Canada have the same rights?

Figure 17-5 This photograph shows one person who has achieved a goal that might not have been possible if human rights were not respected in Canada. Winnipeg's Kirby Cote, a visually impaired swimmer, holds several world records in competitions for people with disabilities. In 2000, she became the first athlete with a disability to compete against able-bodied competitors at the Canada Games. How does this photograph reflect the way in which human rights are respected in Canada?

The Right to Health Care

Canada's universal health care system is seen as a model for health care by many countries around the world. However, cutbacks threaten to dismantle the public health care system. Waiting lists for hospital procedures have grown longer. There is a shortage of doctors and nurses. Many hospitals are unable to cope with the number of patients they have. In some cases, patients have died because they could not get medical help in time. Today, procedures such as eye examinations and physiotherapy are no longer covered by some provincial health care plans. Patients are being charged user fees for services that were once provided to everyone free of charge. Private clinics are springing up to provide services to those who can afford to pay for them. What effect might privatization have on the basic human right to health care?

FastFacts

According to Amnesty International, very few countries do not violate human rights in some way. In 2004, only the Netherlands, Norway, Denmark, Iceland, and Costa Rica were identified as countries with no human rights violations. In what ways do you think that other democratic countries, including Canada, violate human rights?

Voices

The Right to Health

Today, the number of private health care providers in Canada is growing. Those who support private health care believe it is the only way to meet the demand for medical services. Those who oppose it believe that it opens the door to a two-tier medical system dominated by multinational corporations and the effects of globalization.

Canadians are looking to new treatments and technologies to keep them in optimum health, and are happy to pay for what cannot be provided in the public system. That leaves an important role for private health care. The public sector doesn't have the resources to purchase and utilize these new technologies. This is an interesting and dynamic time in this country. There's an enormous sense of frustration with the public system. There are close to a million [people] on waiting lists, and these people are tired of putting their lives on hold.

Source: Dr. Brian Day (president of the Canadian Medical Association), "The Rise of Private Care in Canada," *Maclean's*, April 25, 2006.

Multinational insurance companies could … challenge regulations that aim to ensure that Canadians' access to health care services is based on need rather than the ability to pay. Provincial policies, guided by the Canada Health Act, deliberately discourage the growth of private insurance markets by … setting fee caps, restricting direct and extra billing, and preventing public subsidy of private practices. Such public policies will be viewed as illegal trade barriers.

The [General Agreement on Trade and Services] rules and [the North American Free Trade Agreement] … would work in tandem to accelerate the growth of private insurance markets and to make dislodging foreign insurers from the health sectors next to impossible.

Source: Scott Sinclair, "Supreme Court Health Ruling Oblivious to Trade Treaty Threats," November 5, 2005, Canadian Centre for Policy Alternatives, http://www.policyalternatives.ca/index.cfm?act=news&call=1138&do=article&pA=BB736455.

Motivated by the $3.5 trillion that is spent globally on health care every year, privatization is being pushed by international bodies like the World Trade Organization, International Monetary Fund, and World Bank. … The Free Trade Area of the Americas would accelerate opening health care across the Americas to private interests. Under this agreement, for-profit health companies would be eligible for government funding just like public hospitals and health care facilities. In Alberta, the passing of Bill 11 means that private health companies are allowed to compete for government funding, to open for-profit facilities, and to sue for compensation if they are not allowed to open.

Source: Rachel Rosen, "Filipino Nurses in Canada," *Network Magazine*, Spring 2001, Volume 4, Number 3, The Canadian Women's Health Network, http://www.cwhn.ca/network-reseau/4-3/4-3pg7.html.

1. What are the arguments in the debate over private health care?
2. In your opinion, what impact does private health care have on individuals and communities?
3. To what extent does globalization affect access to the basic human right to health care?

Global Connections

Human Rights in China

Figure 17-6 Tianjin, in northern China

Globalization has created the opportunity to focus the spotlight on governments that violate human rights. Human rights groups such as Amnesty International and Human Rights Watch monitor all countries to expose their human rights violations. By raising public awareness, these groups place pressure on governments to respect human rights and eliminate inhumane practices.

China, the world's most populous country, has been widely criticized for its human rights violations. Figure 17-7 highlights some of the abuses identified by Amnesty International.

Falun Gong a religious group, banned by the Chinese government, that combines traditional Chinese exercises and meditation with Buddhist teachings

prisoner of conscience a person imprisoned by a state for holding political or religious beliefs the state does not tolerate

Human Rights Violation	Example of Impact on Individuals
Authorities have used vaguely defined national security laws to prosecute peaceful activists.	A woman whose son was killed by police during the Tiananmen Square Massacre in 1989 was placed under house arrest to prevent her from leading political protests.
Freedom of expression and association was denied after many people were evicted from their homes and their land was taken from them without compensation.	A man was sentenced to four years in prison for applying for permission to hold a protest against forced evictions after his family was evicted and their home confiscated (taken away) to clear the way for the 2008 Olympics.
Women's rights were violated because of family planning practices that included forced abortions and sterilizations.	A woman was sent to a labour camp for 18 months for petitioning against authorities after they forced her to have an abortion for violating China's family planning policy by becoming pregnant.
Political activists were detained and imprisoned after posting political protests on the Internet.	A leading member of the Chinese Democratic Party was sentenced to 15 years in prison for subversion (attempting to destabilize the government) after posting articles on the Internet condemning government corruption.
Torture, including beating, electrical shocks, shackling, and deprivation of sleep and food, was reported in many state institutions despite a ban on these practices.	A woman released from prison after serving time for distributing **Falun Gong** materials appeared emaciated (extremely thin) and scarred from prison torture.
The death penalty—reportedly up to 10 000 cases a year—was widely applied for people convicted of non-violent crimes such as drug possession, tax fraud, and embezzlement.	A woman convicted of drug possession was forced to undergo an abortion so that she could be executed under Chinese law, which prevents the execution of pregnant women.
More than 100 Tibetan **prisoners of conscience**, mainly Buddhist monks and nuns, were imprisoned following random arrests.	Two monks from a monastery in Sichuan province were sentenced to three years in prison for distributing posters promoting Tibetan independence.

Figure 17-7 This organizer highlights some of the human rights abuses in China identified by Amnesty International in 2004. In what ways do these acts violate the Universal Declaration of Human Rights?

Figure 17-8 In March 2006, these villagers protested outside their local government offices near Tianjin in northern China. They were demanding compensation for land that was confiscated from them over the last four years. They later took their protest to Beijing in the hope of getting justice from the national government. How does the confiscation of land without compensation violate human rights?

1. What responsibility do you think the citizens and the government of Canada have to respond to human rights violations in other countries?
2. Would the government of China view its actions as violations of the rights of Chinese citizens? Explain.
3. To what extent do you think globalization encourages democracy? To what extent do you think it discourages it? Give reasons for your opinions.

Active Citizen

Find out about a human rights organization in your province or territory. Contact a local chapter of the organization to find out what you can do to promote human rights. As a class, organize a fundraising event or create an information awareness display about the human rights issue.

FastFacts

Internet companies play an important role in promoting freedom of expression and information. In 2006, however, Microsoft created an international controversy when it agreed to remove from the websites it hosts any information the Chinese government believed could create social instability. Should the Chinese government have the right to limit its citizens' access to the Internet? Why or why not?

Explore the Issues

1. ***Create a Poster.*** Collect five or six photographs from newspapers, magazines, and the Internet showing different human rights violations around the world today. Be sure to find photos that represent a variety of cultures, ages, and so on. Create a poster of your photos, with headlines or captions to explain each one.

2. ***Research It.*** Many countries violate human rights. Log on to the websites of organizations such as Amnesty International and Human Rights Watch. Then follow the steps in the Skill Path in Chapter 10 (pages 157–158) to do research on human rights violations in one country other than China. Prepare a visual or written report of your findings.

Democracy and Human Rights

Question for Inquiry

- **What impact does the quest for democracy have on individuals and communities?**

Figure 17-9 The photo on the left shows Six Nations protesters in Caledonia, Ontario, in April 2006. They are protesting against a housing development on land they claim belongs to them. (In August 2006, a court ruled that the land belongs to the Ontario government. However, the protesters were allowed to remain on the site as negotiations continued.) The photo on the right shows a public rally in Ukraine in support of the elected president, Viktor Yanukovich, in January 2005. How much power do you think people have to bring about change in a democratic society?

Is democracy a basic human right? Does democracy ensure people's rights and freedoms? Does it give people power over their own lives? What do you value most about living in a democracy? What does democracy mean to you?

A democracy advances and protects the will of its citizens and provides the means to allow them to express their points of view. In this section, you will have the opportunity to learn about the United Nations Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples and Canada's response to it. Then, as you complete this chapter, you will see what factors have led to a global movement toward democracy.

Democracy and Indigenous Rights

In June 2006, after more than 20 years of discussion and negotiation, the United Nations Human Rights Council passed the draft Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples. This document was the work of international law experts and Indigenous peoples around the world. Its objective is to establish the rights of Indigenous peoples, including the right to self-determination and to reclaim traditional territories. If passed by the UN General Assembly, the Declaration will not be legally binding. However, it is a symbolic gesture to demonstrate support for the rights of Indigenous peoples. Do you think symbolic gestures have any impact in the world? What impact do they have on you?

Voices

Promoting the Rights of Indigenous Peoples

Canada played a key role in creating the Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples. Yet in 2006, the Canadian government joined the governments of Australia, New Zealand, and the United States in voting against the Declaration in the United Nations.

In October 2006, the Assembly of First Nations, the Inuit Tapiriit Kanatami, and the Métis National Council joined Indigenous peoples around the world in calling for all members of the UN General Assembly to adopt the Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples.

This Declaration affirms diverse rights regarding lands, territories, and resources that are essential to the cultural identities of Indigenous peoples and the fulfillment of their basic human rights. We are confident that the General Assembly will adopt this Declaration, despite Canada's stated opposition to date.

Source: Phil Fontaine, National Chief of the Assembly of First Nations, 18 October 2006, http://www.afn.ca/cmslib/general/nr.pdf.

The Declaration is aimed at making nation states more accountable to world opinion in their treatment of Indigenous peoples. It promotes the fundamental rights of Indigenous peoples while giving nation states incentive and opportunity to bring their policies up to date with modern human rights values and standards. Inuit urge Canada to resume its position of leadership on human rights issues.

Source: Mary Simon, President of the Inuit Tapiriit Kanatami, 18 October 2006, http://www.afn.ca/cmslib/general/nr.pdf.

By ignoring Indigenous rights to self-determination, Canada is sending a negative message to the world. … By standing united, Aboriginal peoples are clearly determined to secure our right to self-determination as defined in international law.

Source: Clément Chartier, President of the Métis National Council, 18 October 2006, http://www.afn.ca/cmslib/general/nr.pdf.

1. a) Identify the three perspectives that are represented by these quotes. Summarize the reasons they offer for supporting the Declaration.
   b) Speculate on reasons why the governments of Canada, Australia, New Zealand, and the United States oppose the Declaration.
   c) How might their decision affect Indigenous peoples in their countries? What impact might this have in other countries around the world?
2. An independent public opinion poll conducted in November 2006 revealed that the majority of Canadians want their government to support the rights of Indigenous peoples. Do you agree with this point of view? Express your thoughts in your journal.

Web Link

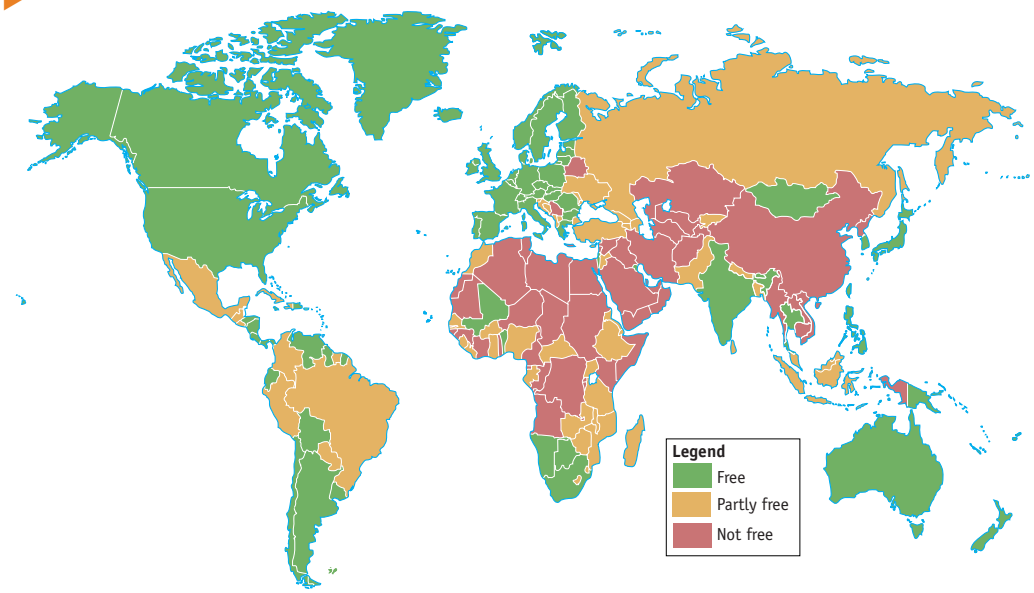
Follow the link on the *Living in a Globalizing World* website and read the Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples. What rights do you think countries such as Canada, Australia, New Zealand, and the United States objected to and why?

Spreading Democracy in a Global World

For centuries, in different places and at different times, people have struggled to achieve democracy. While most countries call themselves democracies, in reality many are not. Democracy is far from universal, and it is not without its own challenges and pitfalls. Yet in the last three decades many corrupt **authoritarian** regimes have fallen, and in their place are new democratic states that embrace human rights and democratic values.

authoritarian enforcing strict obedience to authority as opposed to encouraging individual freedom

The Map of Freedom



Figures 17-10 This map from Freedom House shows those countries that are free, partly free, and not free in 2006. Freedom House defines freedom as "the opportunity to act spontaneously in a variety of fields outside the control of government … in two broad categories: political rights and civil liberties." These standards are based on the Universal Declaration of Human Rights. What patterns can you identify? What continents have the greatest number of "not free" nations? What might account for this?

Reading Guide

When you analyze a thematic map, read the title and the legend first to find out what the map is about.

Sometimes, the transition to democracy is the result of violence and open conflict. Today, however, the agent of change is more often "people power"—non-violent civil resistance. Tactics such as boycotts, mass protests, strikes, blockades, and civil disobedience have led millions of people to question the legitimacy of their authoritarian rulers. As they do, their dissatisfaction spreads to others. Through peaceful perseverance, these civil movements are changing the global political landscape.

Today, promoting human rights and democracy is a major objective for the world's democratic nations, including Canada. However, not everyone agrees on the role these countries should play in promoting democracy. Many policy experts believe the most effective means of bringing about change is through the traditional methods of foreign aid and development. Some political leaders believe that military intervention is the best way to bring democracy to the world's most ruthless and corrupt dictatorships. Another point of view is that democratic countries should shift their priorities in a new direction to promote, fund, and strengthen emerging civil resistance movements. How do you think Canada should respond to the global democracy movement?

FastFacts

In recent years, civil resistance has been a key factor in the transition from authoritarian rule to democracy in more than 70 per cent of countries. In March 2005, mass demonstrations in Kyrgyzstan toppled its authoritarian regime; in Lebanon, one million people marched in a non-violent demonstration for democracy. In November and December 2004, millions of Ukrainians took to the streets to demand free elections. To what extent is "people power" an effective method of bringing about political change?

Explore the Issues

1. ***Practise Your Skills.*** As a class, discuss what democracy means to you and what you believe to be the most important elements of democracy. Use the steps in the Skill Path in this chapter. SKILL PATH
2. ***Assess It.*** Follow the steps in the Skill Path in Chapter 14 (pages 234–235) to assess the ethics of the Canadian government's decision not to support the Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples in June 2006.
3. ***Analyze It.*** Do some research into the civil resistance movement in one country in the 21st century following the steps in the Skill Path in Chapter 10 (pages 157–158). Possible choices include Ukraine, Kyrgyzstan, Lebanon, Georgia, Serbia, and Peru. Prepare a visual timeline highlighting the key events, turning points, and final outcome of the resistance movement. Then analyze the impact this quest for democracy has had on individuals and communities.

Chapter Summary and Reflection

Apply and Extend Ideas

1. The United Nations has created a Declaration of the Rights of Indigenous Peoples. Read this document, which you can find by following the links on the *Living in a Globalizing World* website. Then, using a Venn diagram, compare and contrast it with the Universal Declaration of Human Rights.
2. **a)** In what ways should citizens participate in a democracy? What are the implications if citizens fail to participate in a democracy? Discuss these ideas as a class.
   b) Prepare a Declaration of Canadian Citizenship that states what you believe are the responsibilities of good citizenship in Canada.
3. Locate two current news articles, one concerning a human rights violation in Canada and one concerning a human rights violation in another country. Analyze and compare the responses of citizens and governments in both cases. Suggest your own ideas for resolving these issues. Present your findings in a comparison organizer.
4. Choose one method of non-violent action to promote awareness of a local, national, or international human rights issue that is important to you. Some possible actions include
   - writing a letter to a politician or the media
   - creating a petition
   - organizing a fundraiser
   - writing and presenting a speech
   - writing a song, play, or children's book
   - creating a political cartoon, poster, or piece of artwork
   - supporting a project of an IGO, such as one spearheaded by La Francophonie

Practise Your Skill

5. Use the steps in this chapter's Skill Path to conduct a thorough discussion about the ways in which globalization can both encourage and discourage democracy. Use specific examples from this chapter and from further research to support your ideas. SKILL PATH

Reflect on the Chapter Issue

In this chapter, you analyzed relationships between globalization and both democratization and human rights. You are now ready to respond to the Chapter Issue: ***To what extent does globalization affect access to human rights?*** In the chapter, you encountered many examples of human rights violations. On your own, identify one specific example of a human rights violation that catches your interest. Find your example in the text or via independent research. Consider if and how globalization has contributed to causing the human rights violation or could be a means of addressing the problem. As a class, create a T-chart. List students' examples of human rights violations on one side, and ways of addressing the violations on the other side. Add a checkmark on either side if globalization was involved or not. What do the completed charts tell you? Refer to the results in a class discussion about the Chapter Issue. Use the method of discussion outlined in the Skill Path for this chapter.

This exploration will help you to continue to develop a personal point of view about the Main Issue for Part 4: ***Should I, as a citizen, respond to globalization?***